

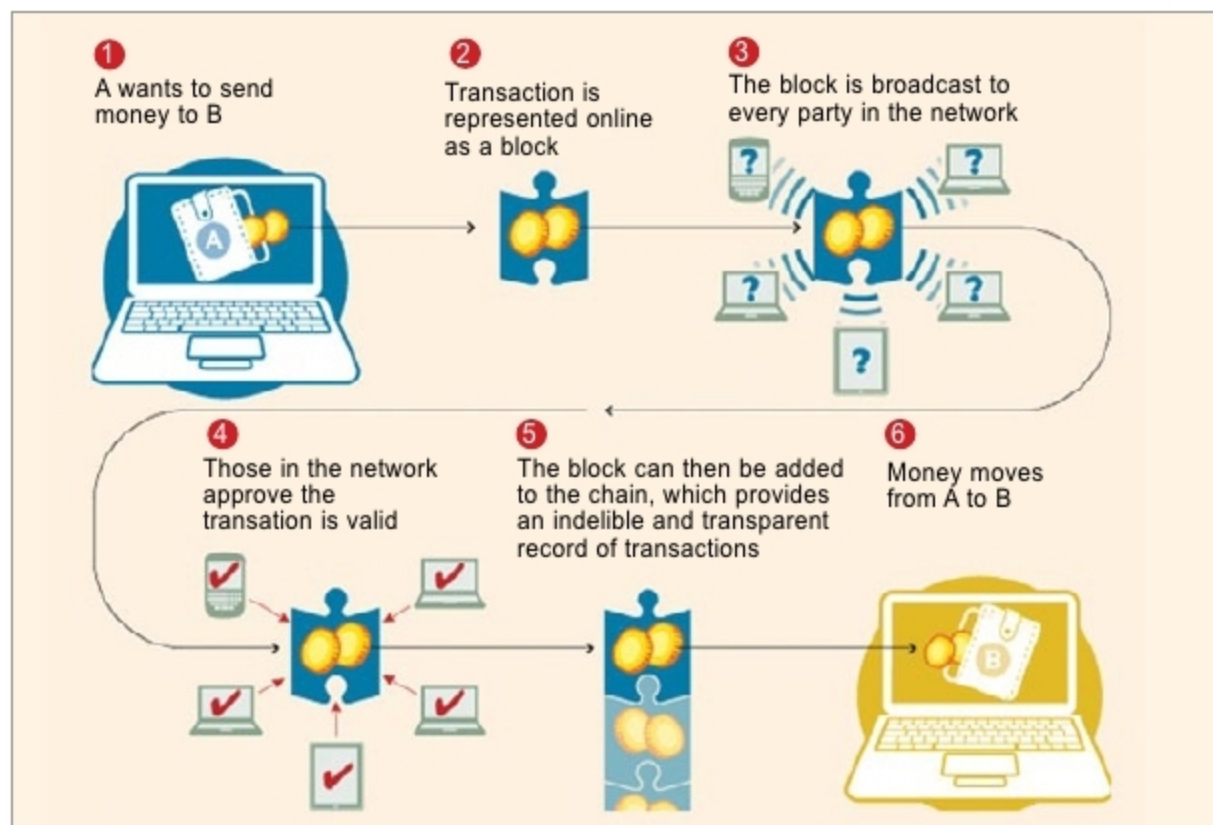


Fig. 1: How blockchain works

participant controls the data or information, and every one of them can verify the records of the transaction partners directly, without any intermediary.

Peer-to-peer transmission. Communication occurs directly between peers instead of through a central node. Every node stores and forwards information to all other nodes.

Transparency with pseudonymity. Every transaction and its associated value is visible to anyone with access to the system. Every node or user on a blockchain has a unique 30+ character alphanumeric address that identifies it. Users can choose to remain anonymous or provide proof of their identity to others. Transactions take place between blockchain addresses.

Record irreversibility. When the transaction is entered in the database and the accounts are updated, records cannot be altered because these are linked to every transaction record that is previously recorded. Various types of computational algorithms and proposed approaches are deployed to ensure that recording on the database is permanent, ordered in proper sequence and available to all others on the network.

Computational logic. Because of the digital nature of the ledger, blockchain transactions cannot be tied to computational logic and programmed. So, users can set up algorithms and

rules that automatically trigger transactions between nodes.

How blockchain works

Blockchain is a new concept when compared to traditional financial practices and involves a series of complex steps. The following points highlight the processes in a blockchain. The first few steps are simple to understand, but the subsequent steps become complicated as transactions mature.

Transaction initiation. To run any business, it is necessary to have currency transactions. For example, party A wants to buy some goods from party B, for which the former has to perform some cash/online transactions with the latter. Now, assume that A and B are Bitcoin users. And, A wants to send money to B in exchange for the goods. This is the first stage of the blockchain process.

Identity encryption. In blockchain domain, both A and B are in the form of cryptographic keys holding unique public and private keys. Main objective of the private key is to ensure that only that user who owns the key can access and edit any specific part of the blockchain in an exclusive manner, and no editing can be done by any other entity. As each key is modified within its own domain, it keeps the whole chain coordinated in an efficient manner.

Block creation. When A starts

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